

Chapter Two – The Man Without a Name

The stranger was carried into the quiet bamboo infirmary of the GNS Clan, where **Master GNS** personally examined every wound upon his battered body.

She was a woman whose age was impossible to determine. Though her snow-white hair flowed gracefully behind her, her complexion remained youthful and serene, as if untouched by the passage of time. She wore elegant robes of ivory embroidered with golden lotus flowers, and her calm eyes reflected both profound wisdom and boundless compassion.

Throughout the Jianghu, **Master GNS** was revered as the Matriarch of the GNS Clan and one of the greatest physicians of the age. Countless martial artists had crossed mountains and rivers seeking her miraculous healing arts. It was said that no one who still drew breath was beyond her ability to save.

Yet her reputation was built upon more than medicine alone.

She was the sole living master of the legendary **Buddha Palm Technique**, a martial art that embodied both immense power and infinite mercy. While its devastating forms could subdue even the strongest martial artists with a single strike, its highest realm allowed its practitioner to harmonize chaotic qi, mend damaged meridians, and preserve lives that seemed beyond saving.

As Master GNS carefully examined the unconscious stranger, her expression gradually became solemn.

Multiple sword wounds covered his body.

Hidden weapon injuries had poisoned several meridians.

His internal organs had suffered severe trauma after forcing his qi beyond its limits.

Worst of all was the injury to his head.

The plunge from the towering waterfall had thrown him against submerged rocks, leaving a deep wound at the back of his skull.

Master GNS gently brushed aside his blood-soaked hair before speaking quietly.

"The injuries to his body can be healed."

She paused.

"But the injury to his head..."

"...rests in Heaven's hands."

Standing beside the bed was **Heka**, the **Second Senior Disciple** of the GNS Clan.

"Master..."

"Can he still be saved?"

Master GNS closed her eyes briefly before placing two fingers upon the man's wrist.

"Yes."

"So long as his heart continues to beat, I shall not allow him to die."

Without another word, she began her treatment.

One hundred and eight silver acupuncture needles were inserted with flawless precision, each sealing a critical acupoint.

When the final needle was placed, Master GNS raised her right palm.

A gentle golden radiance slowly enveloped her hand.

The warm and compassionate qi of the **Buddha Palm Technique** flowed into the stranger's body, calming his violent internal energy and protecting his failing heart meridian.

The treatment lasted for nearly three hours.

By the time she withdrew her palm, beads of perspiration glistened upon her forehead.

"He will live."

She looked toward Heka.

"But his recovery will require constant care."

Heka immediately bowed.

"I understand, Master."

For the next ten days, Heka scarcely left the stranger's bedside.

She changed his bandages each morning and evening, prepared medicinal decoctions under Master GNS's guidance, and patiently nursed him through repeated fevers caused by the severe head injury.

Master GNS herself visited several times each day, monitoring the stranger's pulse and adjusting his treatment whenever necessary.

On the morning of the tenth day, as Heka was replacing the herbal compress on the wound at the back of his head, the stranger's fingers twitched.

Slowly...

His eyes opened.

He looked around the unfamiliar room in confusion.

"...Where am I?"

Relief appeared on Heka's face.

"You are in the GNS Clan."

"You have been unconscious for ten days."

The man touched the bandage wrapped around his head.

"My name..."

He frowned deeply.

"I..."

No memories came.

Nothing.

Master GNS quietly stepped forward and gently examined his eyes before taking his pulse once more.

After several moments, she sighed softly.

"The injury has taken his memories."

"He remembers neither his name nor his past."

The stranger lowered his head in silence.

Even the mysterious black bundle that had never left his grasp stirred no memories within him.

When Heka carefully unwrapped it, it revealed an exquisite ****Rare Onyx Steel Box****, its surface engraved with mysterious ancient scriptures that none present could decipher.

Master GNS examined every inch of the box.

"There is no visible lock."

"No hinge."

"No ordinary mechanism."

She attempted several ancient unlocking methods but failed.

Finally, she set the box back upon the table.

"I once heard that the Tang Clan possessed a secret technique capable of opening mechanisms such as this."

"The art vanished with one of their forgotten bloodlines generations ago."

"If that legend is true..."

"...this box will remain sealed until the lost technique is found."

None of them realized that hidden within the Rare Onyx Steel Box rested an ancient key—a key that could awaken a forgotten legacy capable of changing the fate of the entire Jianghu.

